

SINGLE SOURCE OF TRUTH

Voice & Premium Language Guide

Everything your team needs to write, describe, and communicate as Aykah — across every channel, every time. Consolidates Voice Playbook v1, Brand Strategy v2, Premium Language Guide, and Campaign Copy Rules into one document.

CONFIDENTIAL

FOR INTERNAL USE ONLY

AYKAH.CA

Brand DNA

Read this once. Internalize it. Everything flows from here.

MISSION

"Aykah exists to help you write the story of your home, and help organize your life so you can focus on the things that actually matter."

BRAND STAKE

Quietly better.

Sub-line: "Made of what matters."

ORIGIN STORY

Sanya & Salman started as home stagers. When shopping for their own tiny condo, they hit the Canadian wall: beautiful pieces at outrageous prices, or affordable ones with zero service. Aykah was built to fix that gap.

POSITIONING

Article-grade quality + Structube-grade prices + cohesive collection + superior customer service. Reference set: Quince, Cuyana, Maiden Home, Brooklinen, Parachute, Sundays Furniture.

CO-FOUNDERS

Sanya Salehani & Salman Saleem

MODEL

Canadian-owned. Products sourced internationally, sold exclusively in Canada.

BRAND VALUES

Comfort · Integrity · Approachability · Trust

PERSONALITY

Inspiring · Empathetic · Creative

#1 DIFFERENTIATOR

Customer service & material honesty

WE ARE NOT

Structube. Not disposable, not transactional, not cheap.

Typography — Locked

Two fonts. No exceptions. Decided by team vote, April 21, 2026.

FONT	FAMILY	WEIGHTS	USED FOR
Libre Baskerville	'Libre Baskerville', Georgia, serif	400, 700, italic 400	Headings, product names, prices, testimonials (italic), subsections
Manrope	'Manrope', -apple-system, sans-serif	200-800 (use 300-600)	Body text, descriptions, buttons, eyebrows, navigation, forms, UI

Font Import

```
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=Libre+Baskerville:ital,wght@0,400;0,700;1,400&family=Manrope:wght@200;300;400;500;600;700;800&display=swap
rel="stylesheet">
```

DO: Prices always in Libre Baskerville — serif numerals feel more premium. Eyebrows: Manrope 600, UPPERCASE, letter-spacing 3px. Buttons: Manrope 600, UPPERCASE, letter-spacing 1.5px.

NEVER: Use Libre Baskerville for body text. Use Manrope for product names or prices. Add a third font. Go below 10px.

Voice Rules

How Aykah sounds – everywhere, every time.

Four Core Attributes

1. NATURAL & CONVERSATIONAL

Like a founder explaining something clearly. Not a marketing department.

2. CONFIDENT BUT UNDERSTATED

Quality is implied. Confidence comes from specifics, not adjectives.

3. WARM BUT NOT EMOTIONAL

Human, not theatrical. Reads well at a kitchen table, not a runway.

4. DESIGN-AWARE BUT NOT PRETENTIOUS

We know our materials. We don't talk down.

The Voice Spectrum

WE ARE	WE ARE NOT
Warm & welcoming	Stiff or corporate
Confident & knowledgeable	Pushy or salesy
Premium-feeling	Pretentious or exclusive
Helpful & educational	Condescending or dumbed-down
Honest & transparent	Vague or full of marketing fluff
Inspiring & creative	Bland or generic

Emphasize vs. Avoid

EMPHASIZE

How furniture fits into everyday life
 Function and design working together
 Calm, organized, intentional spaces
 Subtle details that make a difference
 Practical benefits without sounding technical

AVOID

Cliches: "timeless elegance," "elevated living"
 Overly emotional or poetic language
 Aggressive sales tone
 Overly technical or clinical explanations
 Comparisons to competitors by name

Tagline & Hook System

The language architecture. Every hook has a place. Use the right one for each context.

Brand Stake (Tagline)

Quietly better.

Two words. Total understatement. Works at \$299 and \$2,800. Lives on wordmark, campaigns, packaging.

Sub-line

Made of what matters.

Proves the "better" by leading with materials. Lives on PDPs, hangtags, About page.

Supporting Hook System

PILLAR	HOOKS	WHERE IT LIVES
Materials	"Real linen. Solid wood. Full-grain leather." / "Materials over marketing."	PDP spec strips, hangtags, Reels
Craft	"Built to last decades, not seasons." / "Considered, where you don't look."	Brand films, About, durability content
Pricing	"Beautifully made — within reach." / "We charge for the wood, not the words."	Homepage, paid social, founder letter
Living	"Made to settle in." / "For the home you actually live in."	Lifestyle imagery, holiday, Reels
Service	"Real people, when it matters." / "Built to last. Backed by people."	Customer service pages, post-purchase email
Voice	"Quietly considered."	About, brand films, founder bios
Campaign	"Touch Wood." / "Substance over surface."	Spring Event, showroom signage, social

Banned Words & Phrases

These words are permanently retired from ALL Aykah communications. No exceptions.

Hard Bans — Never Use

Free shipping

Free returns

100-night trial

Designed in Canada

Made in Canada

Risk-free

Affordable

Cheap

Budget

Discount

Deal

Bargain

Value (as selling point)

Starting from \$X

Save \$X / X% off

As low as

Buy now!

Don't miss out!

Hurry!

Act fast!

Grab yours!

Best price guaranteed

High-quality materials

Luxury experience

Elevated living

Timeless elegance

Premium (until Fall 2026 tier)

Designer-quality

Dupe / dupe of

Game-changer

Unbeatable

Why pay more?

Treat yourself

You deserve this

Approved Vocabulary

Complimentary delivery

Quietly better

Made of what matters

Investment piece

Signature piece

Considered design

Crafted / Constructed

Kiln-dried hardwood

Performance textile

Engineered for longevity

Client care

Design advisory

Explore the collection

Canadian-owned

Beautifully made

Well-designed

Finely made

Within reach

Language Swaps

INSTEAD OF...	WRITE...	WHY
"Free shipping"	Complimentary delivery across Canada	"Complimentary" = gift from brand. Burberry uses this.
"Luxury furniture"	Finely made / Well-designed	We don't claim luxury – we prove quality with materials.
"High-quality materials"	Name the actual material	Every brand says "high-quality." Specificity builds trust.
"Cheap" / "Budget"	Remove entirely	Incompatible with premium positioning.
"Buy now!"	Explore / Discover the collection	We invite, we don't pressure.
"Comfortable"	Describe the sensation	"Sink-in support" beats "comfortable."
"Durable" / "Strong"	Engineered for longevity	Frames lifespan, not resistance.
"Best-seller"	Signature piece / Most coveted	Mass popularity ≠ exclusivity.
"Customer service"	Client care	Elevates the relationship.
"No assembly required!"	Arrives fully assembled	Statement of fact, not excited relief.
\$899.99	\$900 (round numbers)	Round numbers = premium (Zhang & Wadhwa, 2015).
"Don't pay for the markup"	We charge for the wood, not the words	Original is dig-y. Replacement is belief-coded.

Premium Specification Language

How to describe product specs so they justify the price. Every product page should use these terms.

Construction

DON'T SAY	SAY THIS	CERTIFICATION
Wood frame	Kiln-dried hardwood frame — heat-treated to reduce moisture, prevent warping	FSC-certified
Strong joints	Corner-blocked, dowelled joinery	—
Good cushions	Web suspension system — distributes weight evenly, reduces sagging	—
Springs	Sinuous spring suspension — responsive support through 10,000+ compressions	—
Foam	High-density foam, CertiPUR-US certified	CertiPUR-US
Nice fabric	280 GSM performance bouclé, 50K+ Martindale cycles	OEKO-TEX Standard 100
Piping	Self-welt construction — tailored finish in matching fabric	—
Adjustable feet	Precision levelers for stability on any surface	—
Metal legs	Brushed brass-finished steel with electroplated coating	—

Wood Terms (from Product Team)

- Open grain
- Straight grain
- Fine grained
- Natural knots
- Exposed peg detailing
- Wire brushed
- Kiln-dried
- Dovetail construction

Certifications — How to Present

PREMIUM WAY

"Frame: FSC-certified hardwood — sourced from responsibly managed forests"

"Foam: CertiPUR-US certified — tested for harmful chemicals, emissions, and durability"

"Textile: OEKO-TEX Standard 100 — screened against 1,000+ harmful substances"

"Finish: GREENGUARD Gold — meets strict chemical emission limits"

NEVER

"Eco-friendly materials"

"Safe and tested"

"Green certified"

"Environmentally conscious"

(All vague — name the specific certification)

Product Description Template

3-part framework. 200-400 words per product. Voice doesn't change between price points — materials and craft do.

The Framework

PART 1 — THE HOOK (80-120 WORDS)

How does it feel in a room? Sell the lifestyle. Lead with emotion, follow with one material detail.

PART 2 — THE SPECS (60-100 WORDS)

Bullet points. Dimensions, materials, features, suspension, certifications. Be exact. Use premium terms.

PART 3 — CARE (60-80 WORDS)

Cleaning tips, care frequency, what to avoid. Practical and brief.

Example — \$579 Storage Bed (Current Tier)

AURA LIFT-UP STORAGE BED — QUEEN · \$579

"Solid wood frame. Linen-upholstered headboard. Two underbed storage drawers on soft-close runners. Designed for everyday living, with durability that holds up over time. Quietly better."

Example — \$1,899 Storage Bed (Premium Tier, Fall 2026)

AURA KING STORAGE BED — KING · \$1,900

"Kiln-dried solid hardwood frame. Belgian linen headboard with hand-tufted detailing. Four soft-close drawers. CertiPUR-US certified foam headboard padding. Precision levelers on each leg. Built to last decades, not seasons. Quietly better."

Note: Voice stays the same. Materials and craft details scale with price. Price reads as a function of what's in the piece.

Title Tag & Meta Description Formulas

PRODUCT TITLE TAG

[Product Name] - [Material/Feature] | Aykah Furniture Canada

META DESCRIPTION (150-160 CHARS)

[Product Name] in [material/color]. [Key feature]. [Price] CAD. Complimentary delivery across Canada over \$199. Explore at Aykah.

IMAGE ALT TEXT

[Product Name] - [Material/Color] - [Angle/View] - [Context]

"Aura Storage Bed – Belgian Linen – front view in modern bedroom"

Channel Guide

Same voice, adjusted warmth. Use the right hook for each channel.

CHANNEL	WARMTH	FORMALITY	PRIMARY HOOK(S)
Product Pages	Medium	Medium	Sub-line + materials hook
Blog Posts	High	Low-Medium	Living hook + craft hook
Social Media	High	Low	Materials hook + living hook
Email Promos	Medium-High	Low-Medium	Sub-line + product specifics
Customer Service	Very High	Medium	Service hook
About / Brand	High	Medium	Anti-markup hook + voice tag
Paid Social	Medium	Low	"Belgian linen. Solid oak. \$1,299." format
Reels / TikTok	High	Low	Materials hook + craft hook. ASMR audio.
Showroom Signage	Medium	Medium	Materials hook + tagline
Announcement Bar	Low	Medium	Rotate 3 messages, 5-7 sec intervals

Announcement Bar — 3 Rotating Messages

MESSAGE 1

Complimentary delivery across Canada on orders over \$199

MESSAGE 2

Welcome to the new aykah.ca — explore our collections

MESSAGE 3

1-year warranty on all furniture

Social Media Caption Formula

CAPTION STRUCTURE

[Hook — scene or emotion] → [Product + one material detail] → [Brand positioning] → [Soft CTA] → [3-5 hashtags]

"Morning light, warm coffee, nowhere else you'd rather be. The Enigma Sofa in oat linen — 280 GSM performance fabric, built on a kiln-dried hardwood frame. Quietly better. Explore at aykah.ca. #AykahHome #ModernFurnitureCanada"

Email Subject Lines

WRITE

"Introducing the new collection"

"How we choose our oak"

"Your new sofa — a care guide"

"We've been working on something"

NEVER

ALL CAPS subjects

Exclamation marks

Emojis in subject lines

"Last chance!" or "Don't miss out!"

Customer Service Response

RULE: Acknowledge first, solve second. Use customer's first name. Be transparent about policies. End with next steps, not dead ends.

EXAMPLE RESPONSE

"Hi Sarah, thank you for reaching out. I'm sorry the delivery took longer than expected — that's not the experience we want for you. I've looked into your order and here's what's happening..."

Verified Facts — Do Not Deviate

Get these wrong and we erode trust. Verified against live site and founder input.

BRAND NAME Aykah (always capitalized — never "aykah" or "AYKAH")	CO-FOUNDERS Sanya Salehani & Salman Saleem
SHIPPING Complimentary over \$199 CAD. \$19.99 under. Canada only.	CARRIERS FedEx, GLS, AppsCargo, Canada Post
SMALL ITEMS 2-8 business days	LARGE ITEMS 20-25 business days
RETURNS 14-day window. Unused & unassembled. Customer pays return shipping.	RESTOCKING FEE 20% if NOT in original packaging. No fee if in original packaging.
SALE ITEMS Non-refundable.	WARRANTY 1 year. Original purchaser only.
REVIEWS 4.8/5 across 443+ reviews (Loox / Birdeye)	MARKETPLACE Also on Best Buy Canada & Walmart Canada

Store Locations

LOCATION	ADDRESS	PHONE	HOURS
Burnaby, BC (HQ)	7465 Griffiths Dr, V5E 2Y3	(604) 991-2865	Mon-Sat 10:30-6:30, Sun 12-5
Port Coquitlam, BC	114-1655 Broadway St, V3C 2M7	(604) 474-4353	Mon-Sat 10:30-6:30, Sun 12-5
Mississauga, ON	3750b Laird Rd #15, L5L 5Y6	(613) 553-3000	Mon-Sat 10:30-6:30, Sun 12-5

Approved Trust Signals — Use Freely

- Complimentary delivery over \$199 CAD
- 1-year warranty
- 4.8 stars / 443+ reviews
- 3 showrooms across Canada
- Canadian-owned & operated

Photography Direction

DO Warm natural light, golden hour preferred Styled rooms that feel real and lived-in Wood + cream + texture palette Detail shots (grain, stitching, hardware) Canadian homes (condos, townhouses, real spaces) 8-12 images per product minimum	DON'T Cold clinical / fluorescent shots Over-staged rooms that feel like a catalogue Neon accents or trendy colour pops Low-resolution images Generic stock photos Flash-lit product shots
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Colors — Quick Reference

Full design system at 03_Brand_Identity/Colors/aykah-design-system-v1.html

PRIMARY #363B57 (Navy)	ACCENT #B8956A (Gold – decorative only)	ACCENT TEXT #8B6E4A (gold text, links)
ACCENT BUTTON #7D6040 (buttons w/ white text)	IVORY #FAF8F4 (background)	BODY TEXT #2C2C2C

RULE: 60% warm whites (–ivory, –warm, –white) · 30% navy (–primary) · 10% gold + green accents. Never use #B8956A as text – it fails WCAG at 2.78:1.

DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version Log

VERSION	DATE	CHANGES
v1.0	March 2026	Initial Voice Playbook — Lora + Plus Jakarta Sans. "Aesop meets IKEA" positioning.
v1.5	April 18, 2026	Premium Repositioning Strategy added. "Free" banned. Word swap dictionary. Premium spec language. 5 campaign concepts.
v2.0 (this)	April 29, 2026	Full consolidation. Fonts locked: Libre Baskerville + Manrope. Tagline: "Quietly better." / "Made of what matters." "Aesop meets RH" retired → reference set updated. Bridge voice strategy for current tier + premium Fall 2026. All banned words, hooks, channel guide, spec language, templates in one document.

Supersedes: Aykah-Voice-Playbook-v1.html, Aykah-Brand-Strategy-v2.html, aykah-premium-language-guide.html. Those files remain in the project folder for reference but this document is the single source of truth.